



DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

National Diploma: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

PROJECT MANAGEMENT 3

(PRM370S/ PRM371S / PRM372S)

Assignment: Individual Research Project

Due Date: 26th August 2022

OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion of this project, students must fulfil the objectives of this project which include:

- Demonstrate the ability to conduct research and report findings using correct HARVARD referencing.
- Demonstrate the ability to identify and systematically engage the extant body of knowledge in a field of study.
- Produce an original and sound literature review in support of a research paper
- Demonstrate the ability to localize your research and make relevant findings or recommendations.

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

Read and understand the instructions and requirements of the project thoroughly before attempting the assignment.

Scope

Conduct research and produce a literature review report of **8-10 pages** focused on a topic related to “Agile Project Management Methodology” within the Project management field and strictly follow the instructions given below.

The purpose of the literature review is to display an understanding and recognition of the extant body of knowledge and discoveries that predates the current status of the topic of investigation. Demonstrate how literature grounds a study in a particular context of what is known about a topic and provides a foundation for your question being researched. The research question must be derived from an analysis of the business environment in which the study is located.

Remember that the entire point of writing a literature review is to synthesize, or write about the relationships between, the ideas, concepts, and arguments in the materials you will be using. It is important to define the connections and relationships to explain how they come together to represent a body of knowledge in a particular field such as project management.

Requirements

You are required to, as an individual, investigate the dynamics of agile project management. The following broad issues must be addressed:

1. Discuss agile project management and its antecedents (including key artefacts);
2. Discuss traditional project management and its evolution;
3. Explain the strengths and weaknesses of at least two agile project management methodologies;
4. Discuss some challenges of implementation of agile methodologies;
5. Highlight the impact of agile project management on IT projects;
6. Discuss advancements and future projections of agile methodologies.

Steps

- Carry out an investigation of the topic and then compile a report following the structure defined in the instructions. The literature review must provide an overview of recent research focused on the topic. Write a review of the literature directly related to the topic. In the body, move from a general, wider view of the

literature being reviewed to the specific focus of your research (your research question).

- Narrow your research using a **research question** that you must formulate in the introduction section. The question specifically describes what you would like to know about this topic. Explain how your research question grew out of your review (This is used to identify a research focus within a broader research body).
- Use a minimum of 15 sources. At least 12 of these sources must be obtained from articles published in peer-reviewed journals, conference papers, books, and reports.

Remember to....

- Search for and select **credible** literature that relates to your topic and is framed by your question using the guidelines provided in the **Professional Communications 3 (or similar)** class notes. **Google Scholar, Emerald, Scopus** and **EbscoHost** are examples of good databases.
- Use the literature to build a logical argument (and not a library!) that illustrates your ability to engage in a dialogue with the literature. This means using **your own word** to actively interpret the literature and explain the interpretation to the reader.

Do not simply describe or simply list what others have written!

- Group articles into thematic clusters and proceed in a logical order from cluster to cluster. See **Professional Communications 3** class notes for examples of types of themes/subtopics.
- Use linking words! Relational or linking words and phrases are important. For example, if you are grouping writers with similar opinions together, you would use words or phrases such as: *Similarly, in addition, also, subsequently...etc.*
- More importantly, if there is disagreement, you need to indicate clearly that you **are aware** of this by the use of linkers such as: *however, on the other hand, conversely, nevertheless*. Please see **Professional Communications 3** class notes for more examples of linking words/phrases.
- Use language that is appropriate for an academic literature review. Reading many articles will greatly assist you in becoming familiar with the style and tone of such articles.
- You can further enhance your research using library facilities and senior research students or knowledgeable individuals for guidance.

Consistent Effort

Any research project of this nature cannot be left to the last minute. As such, there are several milestones scheduled to guide you on your way. Please work consistently and diligently to successfully complete this assignment.

Report structure:

Do not write your report in bullet points!! Use headings or sub-headings.

- The project report must include the cover page and table of content page
- Ensure that the write-up is **NOT plagiarized or reproduced without original, analytical, critical synthesis of comments and views.**
- A reference list, listing the articles should also be included at the end of the report (**This does not count toward your page limit**).
- Report must be well formatted and presented with good language and grammatical structure, using cohesive and logical arguments reflecting original thinking.

Instructions - Please follow the instructions carefully.

1. **Provide a title, (subtitle) and research question for your research which reflects your message accurately.**

You will be required to choose an appropriate title and subtitle that encapsulates the message of your research paper.

You need to be creative and come up with penetrative questions, realistic and practical enough to elicit potential solutions or challenges. The research must reflect considerable thought given to the topic.

Present a solid argument that substantiates whatever premises the questions are based on.

2. Your literature review report must be formatted as follows:

2.1 Introduction (Ideally a page)

Introduce the topic, the relevance and the broader application areas;

Present an overview of the main concepts and establish the relationships and trends.

Present a solid argument that substantiates whatever premise the question is based on and clearly state the research question for the review;

Explain the organisation – i.e. sequence/themes – of the review;

State the scope of the review – i.e. what is included and what isn't included.

2.2 Literature Review

Organise the literature according to common themes;

Move from a general, wider view of the literature being reviewed to the specific focus of your research topic.

2.3 Main Body (Synthesis of the body of knowledge)

Provide insight into the relationship between your chosen topic and the wider subject area.

e.g. project management in IT and project management in general.

2.4 Summary

Briefly summarise the important aspects of the existing body of literature.

Identify significant flaws or gaps in existing knowledge: was your research question adequately answered by existing research?

Based on this, outline areas for future research.

3. Use proper referencing style for all research materials used.

Use the university standard Harvard referencing style.

4. Use an appropriate cover page.

The cover page must contain details of the subject, title, your name, student number and date of submission.

The cover page must be signed by all students.

5. You need to strictly adhere to the due date & instructions.

Failure to follow the given structure above, timeline and instructions will result in penalties.

The assignment mark total is 150 Marks.

TECHNICAL WRITING AND DOCUMENT STRUCTURE

- Must have a front cover with personal details and a relevant descriptive topic.
- Font: Arial, Tahoma, Verdana. (Choose one and use it across the document).
- Font size: 11 for body content; 12 bold for headers.
- Spacing: 1.5 lines.
- Must have an automated content page.
- All diagrams and tables must be captioned with the word captioning facility.
- Document must use cross reference functions (for headings, captions, bookmarks, or numbered items).
- Content and front page should not have any header and footer information.
- Document must have a relevant header and page numbers should be at the bottom of the page.
- Page numbering must start at the introduction page.
- Headers and page numbers should be at the bottom of the page.

PROJECT RULES

- **The assignment counts towards 30% of your term 3 mark**, therefore you are required to do thorough research, analysis and write a complimentary report.
- The report must be submitted via the Blackboard link ***provided for submission***:
- A signed plagiarism declaration document must be attached at the end of the document.
- **Plagiarism must be avoided, any instance of plagiarism detected will result in zero marks and the student will be reported to the ethics and disciplinary committee.**
 - **The full report MUST be uploaded in PDF ONLY**

Assignment Due Date: 26th August 2022.

Comments.

1. You are expected to apply the knowledge acquired in subjects such as Profcomm 3, where you're taught how to professionally write and communicate your ideas in an acceptable academic style.
2. The project management component requires you to be creative, analytical and imaginative in understanding the different dynamics of Agile project management methodologies in relation to different organisational contexts.
3. Some examples of topics within Agile Project management include:
 - a. Agile Project Management practice in Healthcare; Manufacturing; construction etc...different domains and contexts (other than IT or Software Development).
 - b. Effective Agile Project Management in Regulated Government Project Environment.
 - c. Best practices of Agile Project Management in Distributed team Environment.

Project Management 3

Term 3 Research Project Assignment

Rubric			
		Mark	Actual
Introduction	Overview (Trends, concepts, definition, relationships....)	20	
	Establish question and present argumentative justification		
Literature/main body	Discussion of the major themes	50	
Findings Reporting	The question addressed, gaps, future research areas	20	
Conclusion	Summary of main points and findings.	20	
Technical Writing	Information Structure and Flow	20	
	Short Clear Sentences & Efficient words		
	Formal Language		
	Spelling & Grammar		
References	Use of correct CPUT Harvard Style	20	
Total Mark		150	
Deductions	No Front Page	-5	
	No Descriptive Title	-5	
	No Question	-10	
	No Automatic Content Page	-5	
	No Headers	-5	
	No Table & Figure Captions if used	-5	
	Incorrect document format (Font, Line spacing etc.)	-5	
	No cross references (when table or diagram is used)	-5	
	No page numbers (as a footer starting with the introduction)	-5	
	Incorrect outline	-10	
	No plagiarism statement (-5 if not signed)	-10	
	Not in a PDF format (Cover, Content)	-10	
	Zipped file	-10	
Cumulative Total			